



February 25, 2026

Nune Mikayelyan
Analyst II
Office of Plan Monitoring
Department of Managed Health Care 980 9th Street, Suite 500
Sacramento, CA 95814

Re: Proposed Contract Termination with Palmdale Regional Medical Center
Block Transfer Filing No. 2026-HOSP-235
Filed on February 17, 2026

Dear Ms. Mikayelyan,

This correspondence is in response to the comment letter received from the Department of Managed Health Care (the “DMHC” or the “Department”), dated February 19, 2026 related to UHC of California’s (“UHC” or the “Plan”) Block Transfer Filing No. 2026-HOSP-235 by **UHC of California** (Plan) for compliance with the requirements of the Knox-Keene Health Care Service Plan Act of 1975, as amended (Cal. Health & Safety Code § 1340 *et seq.*) and the regulations promulgated thereunder (Cal. Code Regs., Tit. 28, § 1000 *et seq.*). For ease of review, the DMHCs comments are in ***bold italic font***, followed by the Plan’s response.

In the event of contract termination, the Filing proposes to remove Palmdale Regional Medical Center (Terminating Hospital) from the Plan’s hospital network. The effective date of contract termination between the Terminating Hospital and the Plan (Termination Date) is currently April 30, 2026.

Please review the following comments and feel free to contact me if you would like to discuss any of the issues before filing the Plan’s response.

1. Regarding the Enrollee Transfer Notice submitted for this Filing, the following information was found missing. Please resubmit the Enrollee Transfer Notice for the Department’s review to include the following:

- a. A brief explanation of why the transfer is necessary due to the termination of the contract between the plan and the Terminated Provider***
- b. A statement informing any enrollee of a point of service product that the Affected Enrollee may be required to pay a larger portion of costs if he or she continues to use his or her current providers, if applicable to the particular Block Transfer.***



Plan Response:

- a. In the event of a termination, the Enrollee Notice will be sent to enrollees who have had services in the past 12 months. These enrollees will not be transferred to a new hospital since they are not assigned to a medical group who uses Palmdale Regional Medical Center as a primary admitting facility.
- b. The Plan confirms that there are no POS enrollees on the UHCCA License.

2. On the Block Transfer Filing Form, the Plan reports zero bed days and zero admits for HMO and PPO enrollees. Please confirm there were zero HMO bed days utilized, zero HMO admits, zero PPO bed days utilized, and zero PPO admits.

Plan Response: The Plan confirms that there were no impacted medical groups for UHCCA (HMO), thus zero bed days and zero admits. UHCPBCA (PPO) bed days and admits do not apply to this UHCCA filing.

3. Please confirm whether the contract termination between the Plan and Palmdale Regional Medical Center impacts Point of Service (POS) enrollees.

Plan Response: The Plan confirms that there are no POS enrollees on the UHCCA License.

4. For each Alternate Hospital, please summarize or confirm the following:

- a. The Plan contacted the hospital regarding the Block Transfer,
- b. Any concerns expressed by the hospital regarding its ability to accommodate the hospital-based needs of enrollees redirected by the Block Transfer.

Plan Response: The Plan confirms that the alternate hospitals were contacted regarding the Block Transfer and had no concerns.

5. In addition to the in-patient services comparison on the Block Transfer portal, please indicate any of the following services that are available at the Terminating Hospital, but not available at the Alternate Hospitals:

- a. Any out-patient or in-patient services

If any services are not available at the Alternate Hospitals, please explain where affected enrollees will receive these services following contract termination.

Plan Response: Coronary ICU, Plastic Surgery, and Spine Surgery services are not available at the alternate hospitals. In the event that Palmdale Regional Medical Center terms, the Plan will allow members to continue to go to Palmdale Regional Medical Center for services under an LOA to ensure enrollees continue to receive



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necessary care and services at their current (pre-termination) in-network benefit level.

6. Please identify the number of enrollees who have a procedure scheduled and authorized by the Plan at the Terminating Hospital post-termination.

Plan Response: The Plan has identified zero enrollees with an open authorization at the terminating hospital. The Plan confirms services within 180 days of the termination date will be at in-network benefit levels per the e-filed Continuity of Care language. Please reference e-filing #20244811.

Thank you, and should the Department have any questions, or would like to discuss the Plan's response, please contact me at 763-361-2801 or via email at smorse1@uhc.com.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Samantha Uiagalelei".

Samantha Uiagalelei
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